

Free time

Unit 4 of 12 · Grammar Study Sheet

Talk about free-time activities, frequency, and what you can/can't do.

What you will be able to do

- ✓ Talk about likes and dislikes
- ✓ Use like / love + -ing
- ✓ Talk about my daily life
- ✓ Use adverbs and expressions of frequency
- ✓ Talk about my abilities with can/can't
- ✓ Write short emails

4 lessons in this unit

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Lesson 4a · 100% identical?

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Topics: collocations · like/love + -ing · /ŋ/

Vocabulary — Verb + noun collocations

go: swimming, running, playing football, going to the gym, going to the cinema, taking the dog for a walk, watching TV, working	
read: a magazine, a book	meet: friends
use: social media, the internet	have: a coffee, a meal
	make: phone calls, a cake

Pronunciation — /ŋ/ — the -ing sound

The "-ing" ending of verbs is pronounced /ɪŋ/. The final letter "g" is NOT pronounced separately — /ŋ/ is one nasal sound.

- playing /ˈpleɪɪŋ/
- listening /ˈlɪs(ə)ɪŋ/
- singing /ˈsɪŋɪŋ/ — has /ŋ/ twice!
- doing /ˈduːɪŋ/

like / love (+ noun / -ing)

After like / love / don't like / hate, use a NOUN or the -ING form of a verb.

Examples:

- They love books. (love + noun)
- They love playing golf. (love + -ing)
- They don't like the same football teams. (like + noun)
- She likes swimming. (likes + -ing)
- I don't like dancing.
- Do they like doing the same things?

Lesson 4b · Free time in the Arctic

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Topics: everyday activities · adverbs of frequency · expressions of frequency

Vocabulary — Everyday activities

do online shopping	go for a walk	have a coffee	make phone calls
play online games	read a book	browse the internet	text friends
use social media	watch videos		

Norbert Rosing is a National Geographic photographer who works in the Arctic.

Adverbs of frequency

These tell HOW OFTEN something happens. Position: AFTER "be", BEFORE other verbs.

100%	always
~80%	usually

~60%	often
~40%	sometimes
~20%	not often
0%	never

Examples:

- I'm often away at the weekend. (after "be")
- I don't often watch TV.
- I never play computer games.
- He's never bored.

Expressions of frequency

Specific frequencies use phrases like "once a year", "every day". They usually go at the END of a sentence.

Examples:

- He goes once a year.
- I drink coffee twice a day.
- We visit my cousins in the summer.
- You can see polar bears every day (between August and November).
- How often do you go to the gym?

Lesson 4c · Extreme sports

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Topics: sports · can/can't

Vocabulary — Sports

baseball	basketball	boxing	cricket
cycling	football (UK) / soccer (US)	hockey	running
sailing	skiing	surfing	swimming
tennis			

Use "play" with ball sports (play football). Use "go" with -ing activities (go swimming). Use "do" with martial arts (do Taekwondo).

Pronunciation — can vs can't

Positive "can" is usually unstressed (weak form /kən/). Negative "can't" is stressed and clearer (/kɑ:nt/ in BrE).

- I /kən/ swim. (weak — positive)
- I /kɑ:nt/ play tennis. (strong — negative)
- CAN you play the guitar? (strong in question)

can / can't (+ adverb)

"can" is a modal verb showing ability. Same form for all subjects (NO -s). Followed by the BASE form of the verb.

+	Subject + can + base verb
–	Subject + can't (cannot) + base verb
?	Can + subject + base verb? — Yes, I can. / No, I can't.
adv	Adverbs of degree go after: very well / a bit. "How well...?"

Examples:

- He can jump between 20 and 30 metres.
- He can't see very well.
- Can you speak French? — Yes, I can. / No, I can't.
- I can speak French a bit.
- How well can you swim?

Lesson 4d · A gap year + short emails + free time

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Topics: gap year · abilities and interests · sentence stress · writing short emails · video lesson · free time

Vocabulary — Gap year (4d)

gap year	volunteer	volunteer work	orphan
cub	enthusiastic	good at + -ing	

Vocabulary — Video — Free-time passions (4f)

passion	hobby	free-time activity	I love ...
I really enjoy ...			

Pronunciation — Sentence stress (4d)

Stress CONTENT words (nouns, main verbs, adjectives, adverbs). Don't stress function words (a, the, of, am).

- Are you GOOD at WRITING?
- I'm GOOD at WRITING.
- CAN you TEACH?
- I CAN'T speak ENGLISH very WELL.
- I LOVE ANimals!

Real life — Talking about abilities and interests (4d)

Common phrases for asking and saying what you can do and what you like.

Examples:

- Are you good at teaching?
- How well can you speak English?
- Can you teach?

- Do you like animals?
- I can speak English well.
- I can't go for eighteen months.
- I'm (not very) good at writing.
- I (don't) like animals. / I love them!

Writing skill — Short emails (4e)

In short, friendly emails: use informal greetings (Hi ...), contractions (I'm, I'd), and casual sign-offs.

Examples:

- Hi Sarah, / Hello Tom,
- I'm great, thanks! / I'd love to come.
- Looking forward to seeing you. / See you soon.
- Bye / Cheers / Best wishes,